Ad Portfolio: Before & After

Chidera Ikenna-Obi · Concept redesigns

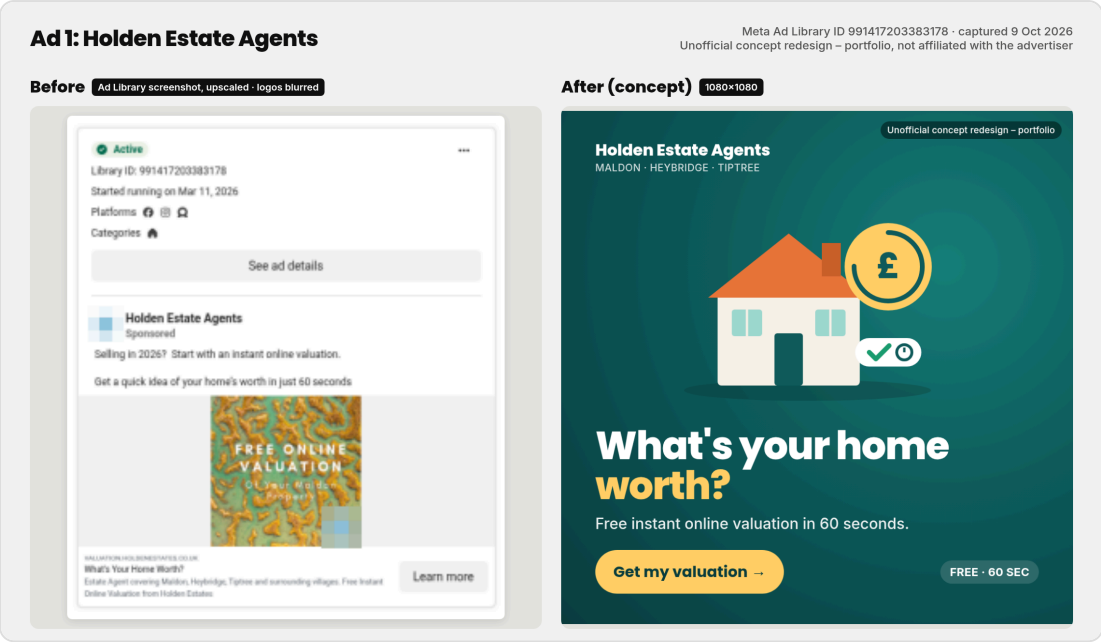
Unofficial spec redesigns of publicly visible ads in the Meta Ad Library, made as portfolio exercises; not affiliated with or endorsed by the advertisers.

Five active UK Meta ads (captured 9 Oct 2026) from estate agents, a driving school, a plumber and a cleaning company. For each one: what's weak, a mobile-first concept redesign, rewritten copy, and why the new version is stronger.

Concept designs I made and directed myself. Unofficial spec redesigns: not commissioned by, affiliated with or endorsed by the advertisers. Advertiser logos in the "before" screenshots are blurred.

Ad 1: Holden Estate Agents

Library ID 991417203383178 · Started Mar 11, 2026 · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=991417203383178



Busy patterned "FREE ONLINE VALUATION" tile → one clear question, a simple house-and-£ illustration, and a "Get my valuation" CTA.

What's weak (general practice)

- Busy topographic pattern sits directly behind white text, so contrast and phone-size legibility are weak (general practice: strong contrast, one focal point).
- Abstract image shows no home and no sign of the valuation tool, so the offer is not visual (general practice: the image should show the offer).
- The real hook ("What's your home worth?") is only in the headline under the image, not in the creative.
- Generic "Learn more" button; nothing tells the viewer the next step is a 60-second valuation (general practice: specific CTA).
- Primary text opens on a generic "Selling in 2026?" and leaves the local areas (Maldon, Heybridge, Tiptree) to the small link description.

New copy

Primary: What's your home worth? Find out with a free instant online valuation in 60 seconds.
Selling in 2026? Start here. Holden Estate Agents cover Maldon, Heybridge, Tiptree and the surrounding villages.
Headline: Free home valuation in 60 seconds
CTA: Get quote (on-image cue: "Get my valuation →")

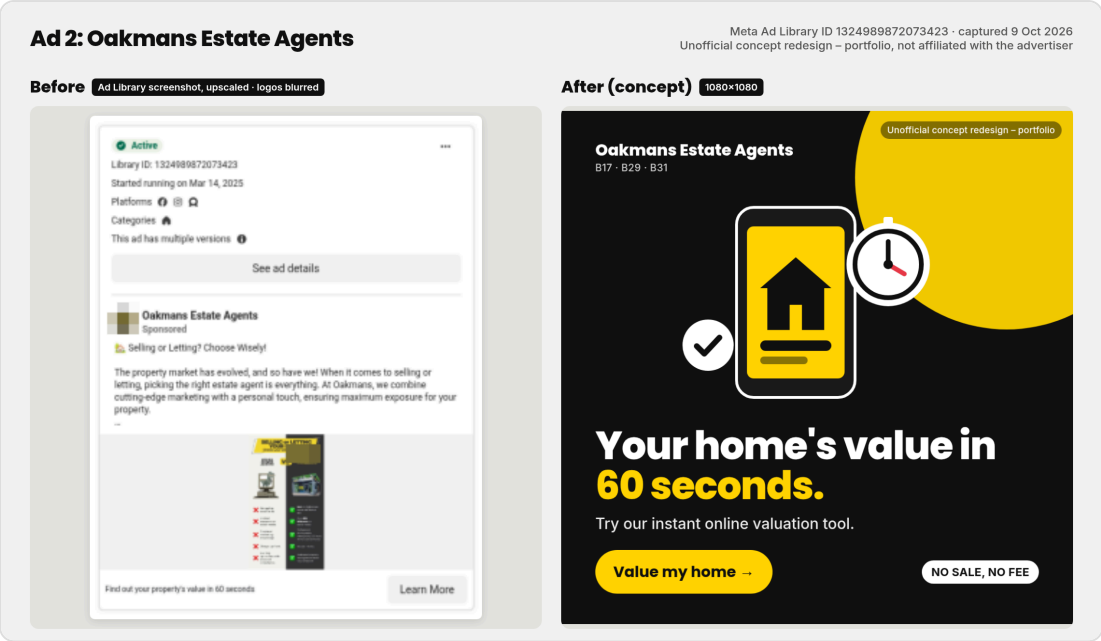
Why it's stronger

- One focal point (house + £ gauge) on a calm gradient, so the white and yellow type has strong contrast at phone size.
- The question hook, the "free · 60 seconds" offer and the brand are all readable in the image itself, not only in the caption.
- The CTA says what happens next, and the local areas sit right under the brand name.

Unofficial concept redesign – portfolio. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Holden Estate Agents. Logos not reproduced; business name set in plain type.

Ad 2: Oakmans Estate Agents

Library ID 1324989872073423 · Started Mar 14, 2025 · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1324989872073423



Text-heavy yellow/black poster and ~180-word caption → one 60-second valuation promise, one proof chip, a short checklist caption.

What's weak (general practice)

- The image is a dense poster with tiny type, many icons and ticks/crosses; at feed size almost none of it is readable (general practice: minimal on-image text, mobile legibility).
- Primary text runs to about 180 words with five emoji bullets; the valuation offer sits at the very end, below "see more".
- Generic hook ("Selling or Letting? Choose Wisely!") instead of leading with the benefit or the local postcodes.
- There is no single offer or focal point: the poster competes between services, comparisons and a photo panel (general practice: one focal point).
- Generic "Learn More" button.

New copy

Primary: Selling or letting in B17, B29 or B31? Find out what your property's worth in under 60 seconds.
✅ No.1 on Rightmove across B17, B29 & B31
✅ No sale, no fee: you only pay when we succeed
✅ Photography, videography, 3D tours & drone footage
Tap below to try our instant valuation tool.
Headline: Your property's value in 60 seconds
CTA: Get quote (on-image cue: "Value my home →")

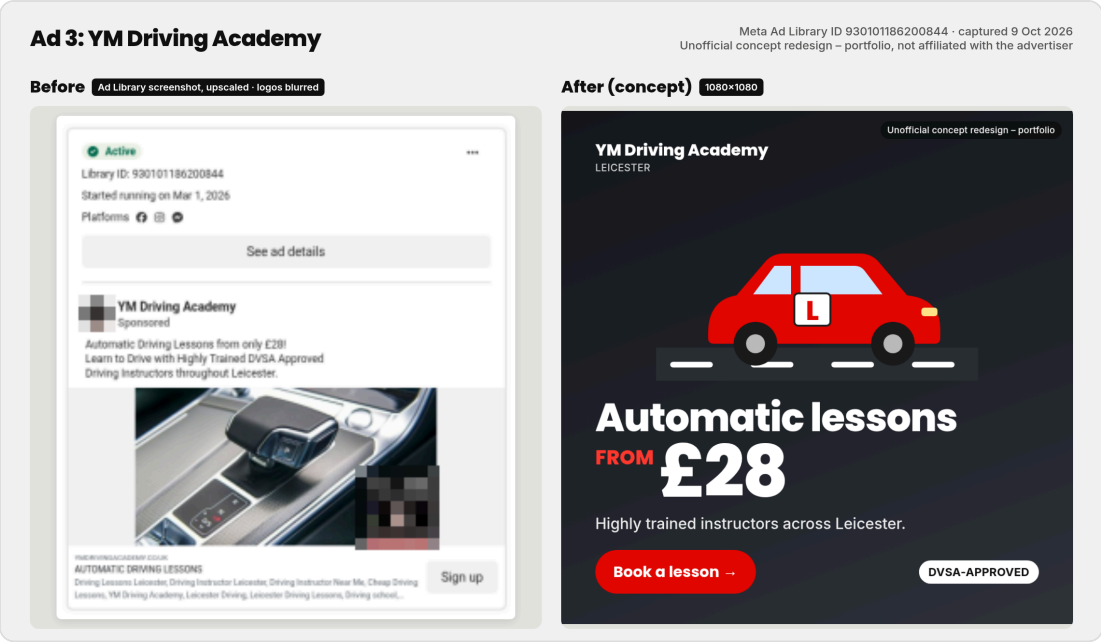
Why it's stronger

- One headline, one illustration and one proof chip ("No sale, no fee") replace a poster of small text.
- The offer and the postcodes are in the first line of copy, above "see more"; the strongest proof points from the original become three scannable ticks.
- Keeps a yellow-on-black palette that echoes the original, but with large type and a clear CTA.

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Ad 3: YM Driving Academy

Library ID 930101186200844 · Started Mar 1, 2026 · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=930101186200844



Gear-stick photo with the price hidden in the caption → "Automatic lessons from £28" as the hero, a learner-car illustration and a clean description.

What's weak (general practice)

- The strongest hook, "from only £28", is only in the primary text; the image has no price (general practice: lead with the offer in the creative).
- Close-up gear-stick product shot with no learner, instructor or L-plate, so it does not read as "driving lessons" at a glance.
- Logo box and phone-number panel crowd the right edge of the image.
- The link description is a long keyword list ("Driving Lessons Leicester, Driving Instructor Near Me...") that reads as spammy and pushes out useful information.
- Generic "Sign up" button.

New copy

Primary: Automatic driving lessons in Leicester from only £28.
Learn to drive with highly trained, DVSA-approved driving instructors throughout Leicester. Book your lesson today.
Headline: Automatic lessons from £28
CTA: Book now (link description: "DVSA-approved instructors · Leicester")

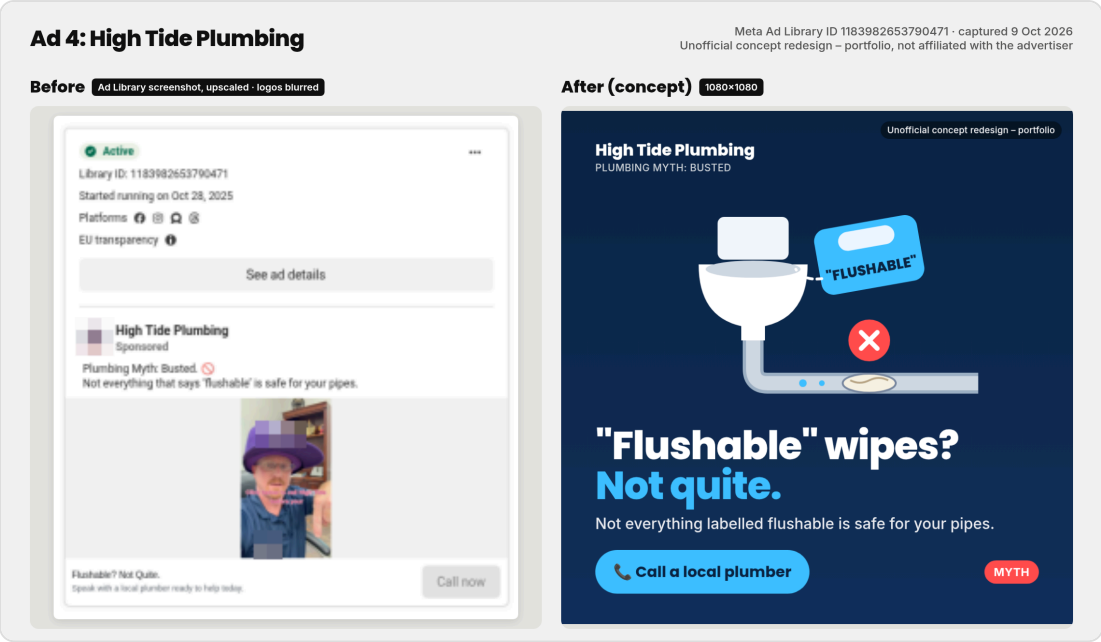
Why it's stronger

- The price becomes the visual hero, so the reason to click is visible without reading the caption.
- A simple learner car with an L-plate says "driving lessons" instantly, with no stock photography.
- A clean link description and a "Book now" button replace the keyword list and the vague "Sign up".

Unofficial concept redesign – portfolio. Not affiliated with or endorsed by YM Driving Academy. Logos not reproduced; business name set in plain type.

Ad 4: High Tide Plumbing

Library ID 1183982653790471 · Started Oct 28, 2025 · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1183982653790471



Headshot that doesn't match the myth message → a toilet-to-pipe "flushable" wipe illustration with the myth-busting line on the image.

What's weak (general practice)

- The image (a man in a cap against a warm background) does not illustrate the flushable-wipes myth, so image and message disconnect (general practice: the visual should carry the message).
- There is no text on the image; the "Flushable? Not quite." hook only appears in the caption and headline.
- Vague link text ("Speak with a local plumber ready to help today"), with no area named or reason to call now.
- The "Call now" button appears greyed and low-contrast in the card (general practice: a visible CTA).
- Short primary text with no benefit or next step.

New copy

Primary: Plumbing myth: "flushable" wipes are safe for your pipes. Busted. 🚫
Not everything that says 'flushable' is safe for your pipes. Worried about a slow drain or a blockage? Speak with a local plumber ready to help today.
Headline: Flushable? Not quite.
CTA: Call now

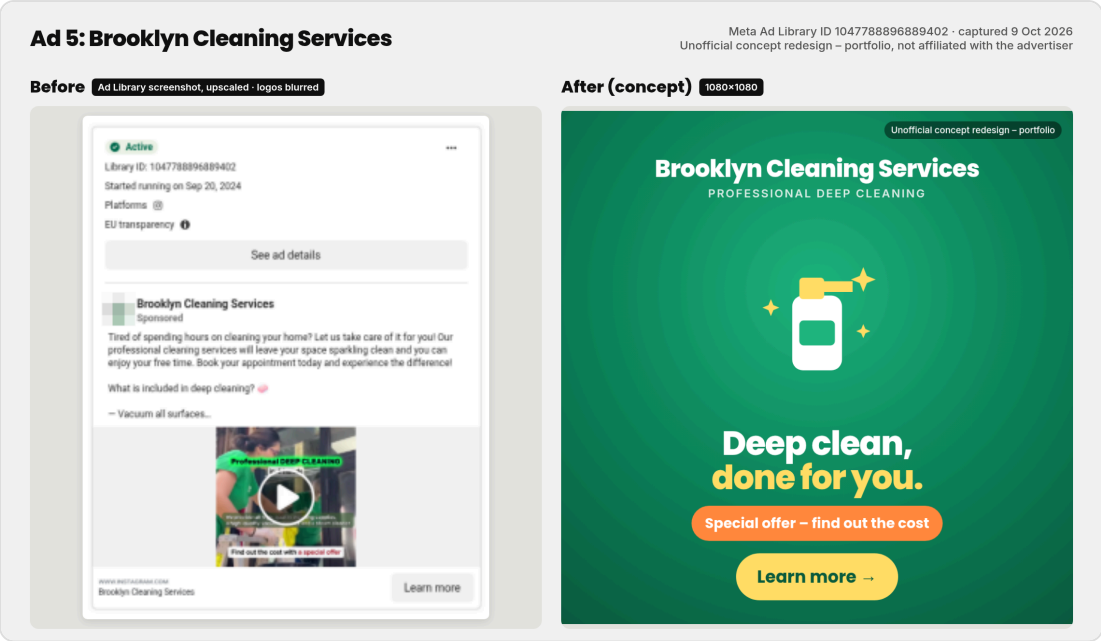
Why it's stronger

- The illustration shows the myth (a "flushable" pack, a toilet and a blocked pipe), so the image and copy tell one story.
- The hook is on the image in large type, so it works when scrolling past.
- A high-contrast "Call a local plumber" cue and a clear next step in the copy.

Unofficial concept redesign – portfolio. Not affiliated with or endorsed by High Tide Plumbing. Logos not reproduced; business name set in plain type.

Ad 5: Brooklyn Cleaning Services

Library ID 1047788896889402 · Started Sep 20, 2024 · https://www.facebook.com/ads/library/?id=1047788896889402



Unbranded first frame and ~230-word list caption → 11.5 s 9:16 video with the brand and offer in frame 1, burned-in captions and a short grouped caption.

What's weak (Meta video guidance)

- The brand is not on the first frame. Meta's guidance says to capture attention quickly with brand imagery at the start (Meta, Building video for mobile feed) and to "feature your brand and key message within the first 3 seconds" (Meta Business Help Center, Instagram video ads).
- No captions are visible in the captured frame. Meta advises designing for sound off with captions and text (Meta, Building video for mobile feed; Meta Business Help Center).
- The length can't be read in the Library (0:00 / 0:00), so it can't be confirmed against Meta's note that feed videos under 15 seconds tend to perform best (Meta Business Help Center).
- The primary text is about 230 words of bullets mixing three services; the "special offer" only appears on screen, not in the copy (general practice: one clear offer, scannable copy).
- Generic "Learn more" button.

New copy

Primary: Deep clean, done for you. ✨ Find out the cost with our special offer.
Kitchen, bathroom and every room, top to bottom:
• Oven, stove, fridge, microwave and hood
• Toilets, baths, showers and limescale on taps
• Floors, windows, lamps and furniture
Deep, regular and after-renovation cleans for homes and commercial premises. Book now and let us make your space shine!
Headline: Deep cleaning: see our special offer
CTA: Get offer (end card cue: "Learn more →")

Why it's stronger

- Brand name, the "Deep clean, done for you" hook and the special offer are all on screen from 0 to 3 seconds.
- Burned-in caption boxes on every frame make it work with the sound off; an SRT sidecar is included too.
- At 11.5 seconds it stays under 15 seconds, and the 230-word list becomes three grouped bullets, with the full list left for the landing page.

Unofficial concept redesign – portfolio. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Brooklyn Cleaning Services. Logos not reproduced; business name set in plain type.

Thank you

Principles applied across all five concepts:

- One hook, one focal point, one offer, with minimal on-image text
- The brand name is clearly placed and the CTA says what happens next
- The first line of copy works before "see more"; the rest is scannable
- Video: brand and offer in the first 3 seconds, captions for sound off, under 15 seconds

Sources: Meta, Building video for mobile feed (https://en-gb.facebook.com/business/news/building-video-for-mobile-feed); Meta Business Help Center, Best practices for Instagram video ads (https://www.facebook.com/business/help/188534925073536). Static-image points are general practice, not Meta rules.

These are unpaid spec concepts that I made and directed. No advertiser was contacted, nothing was published and no results are claimed. Chidera Ikenna-Obi